



Volcanoes

Volcanoes are openings in the Earth's crust. Sometimes, magma (melted rock) from just beneath the crust bursts through these openings as a volcanic eruption. Lots of ash and dust shoot out, too.



Making mountains

The Himalayas started to form 50 million years ago, when two moving plates collided. The mountains are still growing! Mount Everest, the tallest peak in the world, is a part of the Himalayan range and is growing $\frac{1}{4}$ in (4 mm) each year.

Fault lines

Earthquakes happen when two plates of the Earth's crust rub against each other. The boundary between the plates is called a fault line.

Earthquakes often occur along the San Andreas Fault.

Drifting continents

The world hasn't always looked like it does now. Millions of years ago, all the land was joined together. Slowly, it broke up and the continents drifted apart.



200 million years ago



135 million years ago



10 million years ago

Cracked crust

The Earth's top layer is made up of giant pieces called "plates." These fit together like a jigsaw puzzle, but they're constantly moving. Volcanoes and earthquakes often happen in the weak spots where plates move against each other.

